FREE MIDI SEQUENCER / MACOS / USER GUIDE

JENITOR

Make a pattern. Keep the good parts.

A generative, polyphonic MIDI sequencer by helysx99. Create in-key phrases, chords and rhythms, then reshape them with controlled randomization.



JENITOR makes MIDI, not sound. Connect it to a software or hardware instrument. Start your DAW transport to play the pattern.

RELEASE	PLATFORM	FORMATS
0.6.2	macOS 14 or later Apple Silicon + Intel	AU instrument AU MIDI FX + VST3

Your first pattern

Install JENITOR, route its MIDI to an instrument, choose KEY and SCALE, and press play. Use RANDOMIZE to try another variation. Lock the lanes you want to keep and adjust ENTROPY for more or less change.

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Install JENITOR

01. Download the macOS installer ZIP from the repository's latest release and extract it. Keep the PDF and START HERE guide for offline reference.

02. Close your DAW. Open the JENITOR installer package in the extracted folder.

03. If macOS blocks the package, first attempt to open it, then open System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway and confirm. Only approve a download you trust.

04. Follow Installer's steps. An administrator password may be required. Choose Customize to select Audio Units, VST3, or both.

05. Restart your DAW. Enable the corresponding plugin format and rescan if JENITOR is not listed.

About this free build: plugin binaries are ad-hoc signed. The installer is unsigned, and the release has no Apple Developer ID or notarization. macOS approval may be necessary. Managed Macs can prohibit overrides.

Manual install: plugin files only

Unzip the VST3 or AU download and close your DAW. In Finder, use Go > Go to Folder... to open these destinations; create missing folders.

VST3: copy JENITOR.vst3 into ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/.
AU: copy JENITOR.component and/or JENITOR MFX.component into ~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/. Restart and rescan. No administrator password is normally needed; macOS approval may still be required (page 11).

Where the installer puts the files

FORMAT	ALL-USERS LOCATION
AU instrument	/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/ JENITOR.component
Logic MIDI FX	/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/ JENITOR MFX.component
VST3	/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/ JENITOR.vst3

Upgrading or removing JENITOR

Keep one installed copy of each format. Move older duplicates outside plugin scan folders before upgrading. To uninstall, close the DAW and move the bundles to Trash; check both the system and home Library locations. Saved DAW projects are separate.

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Route MIDI to an instrument

Logic Pro: use the MIDI FX version

01. Create a software-instrument track and load a sound-producing instrument.

02. In the track's MIDI FX slot, insert JENITOR MFX.

03. Start Logic's transport. The MIDI FX output feeds the instrument on that track.

GENERATE	ROUTE	PLAY
JENITOR MFX	Same track / MIDI FX slot	Instrument

Ableton Live: use VST3

01. Create a MIDI track and load JENITOR VST3.

02. Create a second MIDI track and load an instrument.

03. On the instrument track, set the upper MIDI From chooser to the numbered JENITOR track (e.g. 1-JENITOR), then the lower chooser to JENITOR. Set Monitor: In.

04. Start Live's transport. Keep the generating and sound-producing tracks separate.

GENERATE	ROUTE	PLAY
JENITOR VST3	MIDI From / JENITOR Monitor In	Instrument track

The lower chooser must show JENITOR, not Post FX. You may disable Virtual Out when using the direct route. The unnumbered JENITOR entry is the separate virtual port; AU instruments in Live use that route instead.

Virtual MIDI output: another route

Virtual Out publishes a CoreMIDI source named JENITOR; additional instances use numbered names. Select that source as the MIDI input of your receiving instrument track or app. In another app, also keep the generating DAW's transport running.

> Choose one receiving route: plugin MIDI output or the virtual source. Enabling both to the same instrument can double the notes. MIDI Thru is off by default.

Virtual Port Lead defaults to Auto and affects only the virtual route. For precise alignment, measure your setup with Settings > Calibrate virtual MIDI timing (page 13). Saved Off/manual values are preserved when upgrading; select Auto to use compensation.

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Find your way around

The dark upper zone contains eight modules. The light lower zone contains the step pads, Entropy, Randomize and variation history. ADVANCED opens secondary controls over the module row; close it to return to the eight cards.

CARD	MAIN CONTROLS	WHAT IT CHANGES
CLOCK	Rate, Swing, Steps	Step timing and the pattern length, up to 128 steps.
HARMONY	Style, Key, Scale	The generation style and pitch collection.
RHYTHM	Density, Min, Max, Mode	Where notes happen. Density bounds apply to Density mode.
PITCH	Low, High, Leap, Lock	Pitch range and melodic movement.
CHORD	Voices, Chance, Lock	Maximum voices and chord likelihood.
VELOCITY	Low, High, Lock	MIDI note-velocity bounds.
GATE	Length, Lock	Note duration relative to a step.
OUTPUT	Octave, Activity, Drag MIDI, Virtual Out	Transposition, activity, export and the virtual source.

Working with controls

Drag a knob to change its value. Shift-drag gives finer adjustment; double-click restores its default. The display shows the current control value. Right-click supported knobs and toggles for MIDI learn.

Pages, history and undo

PER PAGE changes how many pads are visible, not the pattern length. Page indicators select another page and turn FOLLOW off. Enable FOLLOW to let the display track playback.

Click a filled variation cell to recall it. Right-click a cell to pin or unpin it. RANDOMIZE records another variation; Undo and Redo walk through your UI edits. Host automation is not recorded as a plugin undo gesture.

The header arrows select presets. Loading a preset resets extension controls to its defaults and disables stored morph overrides. Save your DAW project to retain the full plugin session.

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Scales, styles and locks

Choose a tonal world

Set KEY, then drag SCALE through the category-ordered catalog. Click SCALE to open a searchable list. Type a name or category, use the arrow keys to navigate, and press Return to choose. The display shows the key and scale name while you adjust it.

CATALOG	EXAMPLES
105 entries	Seven diatonic modes; harmonic and melodic minor modes; pentatonic and blues collections; whole tone and diminished; Messiaen modes; bebop; European and altered collections; Japanese scales; Indian thaats; 12-TET maqam approximations; chromatic and Custom.
Custom scale	Open ADVANCED > Custom Scale. Toggle pitch classes relative to the key, then choose USE CUSTOM SCALE. At least one pitch class must remain enabled. The mask is saved with the session.

These are octave-repeating MIDI pitch collections. Regional scale names describe 12-tone equal-tempered approximations; they do not reproduce microtonal tuning or a complete traditional performance practice.

Six generation styles

Melodic favors melodic movement. Arpeggio creates arpeggiated lines. Chord Stabs emphasizes chord hits. Progression favors moving harmony. Bassline focuses on bass-style phrases. Polyrhythm uses rhythmic variation. Rate, bounds and locks still shape the result.

Keep what you like

Locks freeze Rhythm, Pitch, Chord, Velocity or Gate. A locked lane keeps its material when you randomize other lanes; changing bounds can still clamp that material. Clicking a step pad edits the hit and locks Rhythm.

> Try this: choose a scale and range, randomize until the rhythm works, lock Rhythm, then randomize Pitch and Chord. Lock Pitch when you like the melody and explore new velocities or note lengths.

Entropy controls variation within your musical bounds. Low values make more ordered results; high values allow more wandering. It is not an audio effect or a volume control.

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Explore rhythm modes

Choose MODE on the RHYTHM card. Open ADVANCED > Rhythm for secondary controls. Main Steps sets the pattern length; Euclidean mode uses it as its step count.

MODE	HOW TO USE IT
Density	The default constrained-random rhythm. Use Density with Min and Max to bound the hit count.
Euclidean	Set Pulses and Rotation to distribute hits across Steps. The ring previews the result. Zero pulses is silent.
Polymeter	Give Rhythm, Pitch, Velocity and Gate independent loop lengths. Zero follows the main pattern length; longer lanes reuse generated material.
Cellular	Choose Rule 30, 90 or 110, or enter a custom rule from 0 to 255. The grid previews early generations. The pattern evolves per loop.
Probability Curve	Choose Flat, Rising, Falling, Arch or Random. The curve shapes hit probability across the pattern.
Fill	Create periodic denser bursts with Fill Every Bars, Fill Length Steps and Fill Amount.



Explicit rhythm modes and probability can produce counts outside the Density-mode bounds. Cellular evolution uses 256 precomputed generations and then cycles.

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Edit steps and harmony

Per-step detail

Right-click a step pad to select its absolute step in ADVANCED > Step Editor. Use the step selector to reach any step, including a different page.

CONTROL	RESULT
Probability	0-100% chance for the step to trigger. Active-pad brightness reflects this chance.
Ratchets	1-4 repeats within a step. Zero to three dots represent repeats minus one.
Gate type	Normal uses the usual duration; Tie holds through the following step; Staccato shortens it. Ties take priority over ratchets.
Accent	Adds per-step velocity emphasis within the current velocity bounds.

Chord shape and melodic direction

In ADVANCED > Harmony, choose Legacy, Triad, Seventh, Ninth, Sus2, Sus4, Power or Quartal. Add an inversion, then select Close, Open or Spread voicing. The main Voices control remains the maximum voice count; available range and settings can yield fewer voices.

Contour offers Legacy, Ascending, Descending, Arch, Wave or Random. Tonal Gravity biases the line toward the root and chord tones. Interval Limit is measured in scale degrees, with zero meaning Off. Avoid Tritones restricts the leading melody; pitch locks preserve the frozen line.

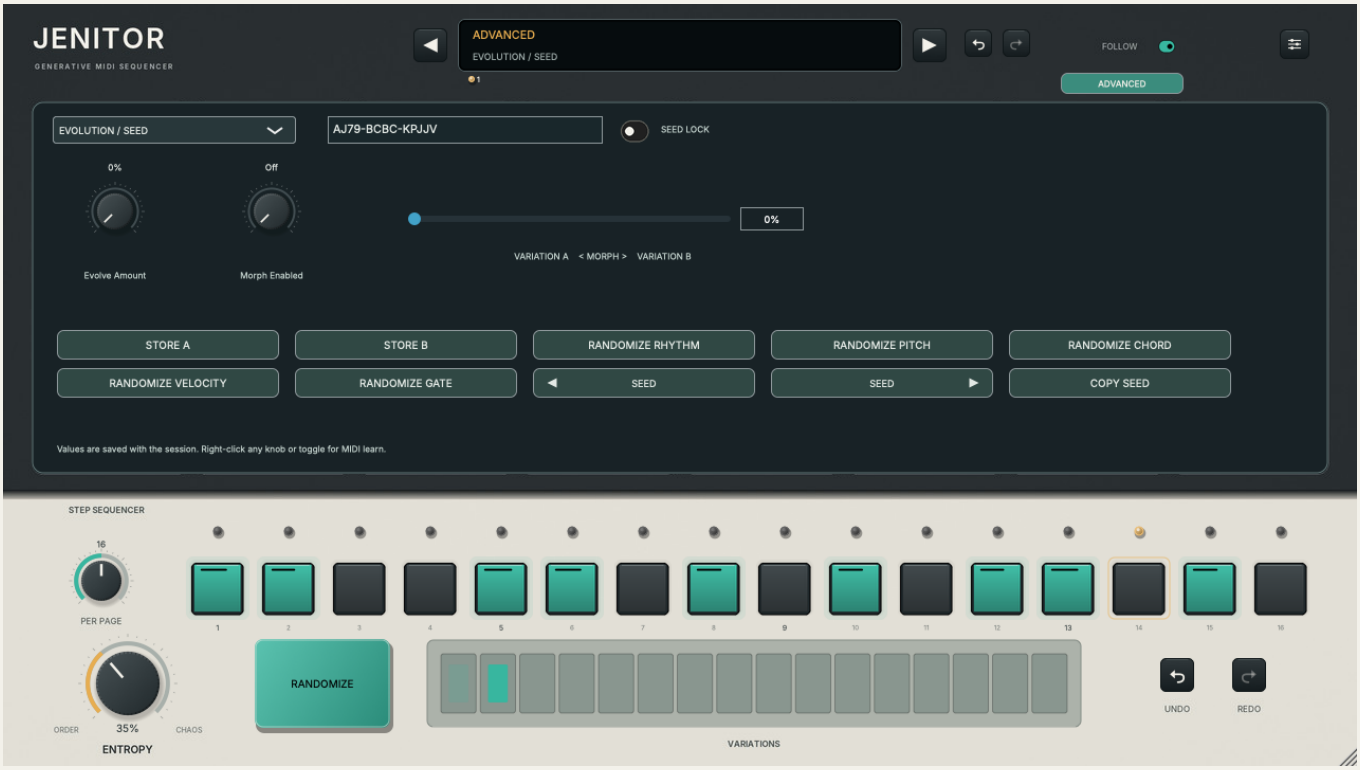
Progression generator

Choose Pop, Jazz ii-V-I, Modal Vamp or Minor, then set Progression Bars. Chord changes use voice leading to favor smaller movements. Progression defaults Off; the existing Progression generation style is a separate main Style choice.

A useful starting point: set Voices to 3, choose Triad and Close voicing, then enable a progression. Keep Evolve and Humanize at zero until the basic phrase feels right.

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Evolve, seeds and morphing



Repeat a result or make a small change

The visible seed identifies the variation together with its settings and frozen lanes. Type or paste a seed in ADVANCED > Evolution / Seed; COPY SEED copies it. The arrows navigate seed history, with the next action creating a variation when there is no later entry.

Seed Lock prevents Randomize from automatically replacing the seed. Explicit seed entry and history recall remain available. Per-lane Randomize buttons affect only their lane and respect its Lock switch.

Evolve introduces bounded changes as loops advance. Locked lanes do not mutate. It varies around the base pattern rather than accumulating an unlimited random walk. Seeking or restarting resets its transport-loop sequence.

Crossfade two variations

01. Store the current variation as A. Change or randomize the pattern, then store B.

02. Enable Morph and move the slider from 0% (A) to 100% (B). Both stored slots are needed.

03. Save the DAW session to keep the snapshots. Current bounds and locks still apply; a preset load disables morph overrides.

Morph interpolates MIDI note count, pitch, velocity and gate. It is not an audio crossfade. For exact recall, retain the settings as well as the seed.

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Humanize and live control

One humanize section

CONTROL	BEHAVIOR
Timing	Adds a small, deterministic late delay, bounded to one eighth of the grid gap. It does not add reported plugin latency.
Velocity	Varies note velocities within the active velocity bounds.
Gate	Varies note lengths.
Groove	Straight, Shuffle, Triplet or MPC-style. Straight keeps manual Swing; the other templates override it.

Timing, velocity and gate amounts default to zero. Start small and compare at your usual tempo. Deterministic behavior means the same seed, settings and transport traversal reproduce the same generated variation.

MIDI input follow

In ADVANCED > MIDI, set Input Follow to Root or Transpose. The latest held input note controls the result. Releasing it falls back to another held note, if any. Root changes the tonal reference within the output range; Transpose uses MIDI note 60 as zero. Off is the default.

Separate melody and chord channels

Melody Channel routes the highest voice; Chord Channel routes the remaining voices. Follow (value 0) uses the shared output MIDI Channel. Configure the receiving instrument or instruments to listen to the intended channels.

Learn a controller

01. Right-click a supported knob or parameter toggle and choose MIDI learn.

02. Move a MIDI CC on your controller. The mapping uses that CC and its MIDI channel.

03. Save the DAW project to retain it. Right-click again to remove the mapping.

Follow, custom-scale note buttons and the morph slider also support learn. CC learn is 7-bit and updates controls on the message thread; it is not sample-accurate automation. MIDI Thru is a separate setting and defaults Off.

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Import and export MIDI

Use an existing clip as a starting point

Drop a .mid or .midi file onto JENITOR. Import quantizes note onsets to a 1/16 grid, up to 128 steps, infers a key and scale, and freezes the detected rhythm. File content produces a deterministic seed. Import is undoable.

Import seeds generation; it does not reproduce an entire arrangement or change the host tempo. Short phrases can fit multiple scales. PPQ-timed files are supported; SMPTE-timed files are not supported in this release.

Drag the result into your DAW

01. Generate a pattern that contains notes. Find the DIN connector icon labeled DRAG MIDI in OUTPUT.

02. Right-click the button to choose Export Scope. For Fixed Bars, also select a length from 1 to 64 bars.

03. Drag the icon into a MIDI-capable track or a file location accepted by your host. An empty export is disabled.

SCOPE	WHAT YOU GET
Fixed Bars	The default. Exports the selected bar length; the initial length is four bars.
Full Loop	Exports the complete current pattern loop.
Current Page	Exports the selected visible step-page range.

Export uses the same playback engine for groove, ratchets, probability and note lengths. It includes note starts within the chosen scope and ends notes at the clip boundary. Notes that began before a page boundary are not added as new page starts.

Changing export scope does not record live incoming MIDI. The drag-out is a generated MIDI file, ready to edit or play through any compatible instrument.

Save the complete session

Save your DAW project to preserve parameters, seed history, frozen lanes, custom scale, morph snapshots and MIDI learn assignments. A MIDI export preserves the rendered notes, not JENITOR's editable generation settings.

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Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	CHECK
No sound	JENITOR has no synth. Load a receiving instrument, start the transport and confirm its MIDI route. Check zero pulses or zero step probability.
Notes play twice	The receiving instrument may be hearing both plugin MIDI and the virtual port. Keep one route. Check MIDI Thru.
Plugin is missing	Use macOS 14+, enable AU/VST3 scanning and restart the DAW. Logic MIDI FX uses JENITOR MFX; Live should use VST3.
The wrong version opens	Look for duplicate JENITOR bundles in both /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins and your home Library. Move the older copies outside scanning folders, restart and rescan.
Randomize barely changes it	Check lane Locks, Seed Lock, Entropy and active Morph overrides. Euclidean and other explicit modes can intentionally constrain the result.
MIDI feels late	Live: upper MIDI From = numbered JENITOR VST3 track; lower = JENITOR; Monitor = In. For the virtual route, select Auto and run timing calibration (page 13). Recalibrate after changing routing or audio configuration.
A drag or import fails	Choose a MIDI track or valid file destination. Import requires PPQ timing. A host may handle native file drops differently.

If macOS still blocks a trusted installed copy

Use the normal Open Anyway approval first. If the host explicitly reports download quarantine, the optional command below removes that attribute only from the three system-installed JENITOR bundles. It does not sign or notarize them. Only run it for files you trust.

```
sudo xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine \
  /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3/JENITOR.vst3 \
  /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/JENITOR.component \
  "/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components/JENITOR MFX.component"
```

For home-folder copies, see START HERE for the corresponding command without sudo. Do not disable Gatekeeper globally. A DAW blocklist may need resetting separately from quarantine.

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Quick reference

ACTION	SHORTCUT / GESTURE
Randomize	R
Undo / Redo	Cmd+Z / Cmd+Shift+Z
Paste a seed code	Cmd+V
Toggle lane locks	1-5: Rhythm, Pitch, Chord, Velocity, Gate
Previous / next preset	Left / Right arrow
Fine knob adjustment	Shift-drag
Reset a knob	Double-click
Edit step detail	Right-click a pad
Recall / pin variation	Click / right-click its history cell

Keyboard shortcuts require the plugin editor to have focus and can be intercepted by the DAW. Space toggles JENITOR's internal clock only when the host provides no transport.

Compatibility defaults

Rhythm: Density. Step probability: 100%. Ratchets: 1. Gate type: Normal. Accent: 0%. Evolve and Humanize amounts: 0. Progression, Morph and Input Follow: Off. Groove: Straight. Melody/Chord Channel: Follow. Virtual Out: On. MIDI Thru: Off. Virtual Port Lead: Auto for new instances; older explicit settings preserved. Export: Fixed Bars.

Current boundaries

Maximum pattern length is 128 steps and maximum polyphony is eight voices. Cellular patterns cycle after 256 generations. Humanize timing is late-only. MIDI import is PPQ-only and uses a 1/16 grid. MIDI learn is channel-specific 7-bit CC. Live changes, host transport traversal and receiving-track routing affect what you hear.

Downloads, help and feedback

github.com/helysx99/Jenitor
Latest release and downloads
Report a problem

Include your JENITOR version, macOS version, Mac architecture, DAW/version, plugin format, routing and steps to reproduce. For generation issues, include the seed and relevant settings. Avoid uploading private projects or personal information.

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Align the virtual MIDI route

Use one JENITOR AU or VST3 instance on the generating track and a separate instrument track receiving its JENITOR virtual port. No companion plugin is required. Direct VST3 MIDI routing remains available and does not use this compensation.

Calibrate your host and audio configuration

01. In the MIDI socket menu, select Virtual Port Lead: Auto. If your DAW uses a different output device from macOS, select that device in the same menu.

02. Temporarily set the JENITOR source track to MIDI From: JENITOR (its own virtual port), All Channels and Monitor: In. Turn JENITOR MIDI Thru and Input Follow Off. Keep the receiving track on its usual virtual input.

03. Mute the receiving instrument during the test. Start the DAW transport, open JENITOR Settings (gear) and choose Calibrate virtual MIDI timing..., then Calibrate. The short test sends tagged controller messages.

04. Wait for the display to show the measured milliseconds and Restart playback. Stop and start the DAW transport to apply the measurement.

05. Restore the source track input you normally use, unmute the instrument, and save the DAW Set. Keep Virtual Port Lead on Auto.

The measurement is stored with the session for the selected output device, sample rate and audio buffer size. Measure each configuration you use. Changing host monitoring, routing, driver settings or compensation can require a new measurement even at the same buffer size.

If measurement does not complete

No MIDI return: check the source track input, Monitor In and Virtual Out. Need setup: start host playback and turn MIDI Thru/Input Follow off. Unstable: keep tempo and audio configuration constant, then repeat. A failed measurement does not overwrite a previous valid timing profile.

Timing limits

Before calibration, Auto estimates device latency plus one host buffer; the estimate can differ from the actual host path. Compensation applies only to the virtual output and leaves direct MIDI timing unchanged. Allow pre-roll if the very first downbeat must be captured: JENITOR cannot send ahead before the host begins processing. External MIDI can still have occasional operating-system or host jitter. An independent receiving app can have a different delay from the calibration path.